FATIMETOU EL BAH

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PROFILE

Final-year PhD candidate at Sciences Po, specialising in applied econometrics and the impact evaluation of public policies using quasi-experimental methods on large-scale administrative and survey data. Four years of experience working with government counterparts to inform policy decisions and with international organisations to support programme evaluations in developing-country settings. Experience teaching impact evaluation methods and communicating findings to varied audiences. Fluent in Arabic, English, and French.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics *2022 - present*
Sciences Po, Paris, France

- Selected in the first cohort of COFRA, France's programme for doctoral research within public administration.
- Research carried out jointly at Sciences Po and the French Ministry of Education.

Master in Public Policy and Development *2021 - 2022*
Paris School of Economics, Paris, France

Master in Economics *2019 - 2021*
Sciences Po, Paris, France

BSc in Industrial and Systems Engineering *2015 - 2019*
Wright State University, Ohio, USA

EXPERIENCE

Research and Evaluation Officer *2022 - present*
DEPP, Statistical Service of the French Ministry of Education, Paris, France

- Evaluation of the short- and long-term effects of a French national class-size reduction reform targeting disadvantaged schools, using regression discontinuity and difference-in-differences designs on large-scale administrative data tracking student performance.
- Evaluation of the combined effects of teacher bonus schemes and class-size reduction on teacher retention and well-being in France's disadvantaged schools, using an event-study design on an administrative panel tracking the full teaching workforce since 2008.
- Communication of research findings to varied audiences, writing policy evaluation reports and ministerial briefing notes, and presenting at academic and policy seminars.
- Contribution to a multi-institutional working group (government inspectorate and academic researchers) evaluating the *groupes de besoin* reform in French middle schools.

Evaluation Consultant, Part-Time *2022 - 2023*
FAO Office of Evaluation (OED), Rome, Italy (remote)

- Contribution to thematic and country programme evaluations across FAO's portfolio.

- Contribution to all phases of an impact evaluation of a cash-for-work programme in Somalia, from inception to final reporting.
    - Oversight of the procurement of a data collection partner through a competitive bidding process: drafting of terms of reference, assessment of technical and financial proposals, and preparation of selection and justification reports.
    - Development of data collection protocols, training of enumerators, and supervision of field data collection in a complex fragile-state context.
    - Cleaning, analysis, and interpretation of the resulting household-level survey data, contributing to the programme's baseline report.

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

Policy Evaluation Reports

The long-term effects of class size reduction in priority education on student performance, DEPP Working Paper (2026)

Evaluation of the organisation of French and mathematics instruction in Grades 6 and 7, with Barone et al., DEPP Working Paper (2026)

Working Papers

The Long Reach of Targeted Smaller Classes: Evidence from a National Reform

Higher Pay or Smaller Classes? Retaining Teachers in Hard-to-Staff Schools

TEACHING

Analysis & Evaluation of Public Policies *Fall 2023, Fall 2024*

Master in Public Policy, Teaching Assistant, Sciences Po Paris

Quantitative Methods & Evaluation of Public Policy *Spring 2023*

Master in Public Policy, Lecturer, Sciences Po Paris

MISCELLANEOUS

Software: MS Office, R, Stata, Sphinx, SurveyCTO, ODK

Languages: Arabic (native), French (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)

Volunteering: Tutor and mentor for primary-school students, Entraide Scolaire et Amicale (ESA), since 2025